

Jolly Jolicloud

Jolicloud 1.1, the newest version of the cloud based OS features a slick new interface with a revamped launcher

**Yellow bird, not blue**

YellowBird is a new service that allows user's to click and view 360 degree view of YouTube videos. Visit <http://goo.gl/DLvF>

Who do you trust? Which brands does India's most influential community trust the most? Find out...

Team Digit

With valuable feedback from our readers
readersletter@thinkdigit.com

George Macdonald once said "To be trusted is a greater compliment than to be loved". At Digit, every year, we've been reaching out to our readers all over India. Our mission is to gauge their T-factor on the players in the personal technology space. We've heard our readers out, and have collated and tabulated the results. Here's what India's oldest, and most influential technology community has to say.

Icons Of Trust?

Ideally, a good product would sell more than a bad one. In reality, this is not always the case. There are always variables – marketing and aggressive advertising for instance, can often cover up for a weak product, especially, in a country like India,

where perceptions play an important role in purchase decisions. And perceptions can be swayed in a number of ways.

As a media company ourselves, our job has been primarily one of education, because an informed consumer is an empowered consumer. Empowered to wade through the fancy marketing and jargon, the purple prose and hype, and make a rational pur-



chasing decision, thereby buying something that is reliable and suits his needs.

For you, this survey is a collation of experiences, and will ensure that you, your friends and your family will buy smarter.

For brands this is a reality check allowing them to gauge if they're really listening to their customers (existing or potential).

CELL PHONES

The word cell phones might be a little outdated itself for these converged tiny multimedia computers of today. Distinct categories have emerged, such as smart-phones, PDA phones, touch-phones, camera phones, music phones, etc. The number of models collectively churned out every year is mind-boggling, and no product enjoys so stable a sales curve as cell phones. Neither has any product penetrated the masses so thoroughly.

HOW WE TRUSTED**How is trust calculated?**

All respondents are asked to complete a rather long and comprehensive questionnaire, which aims at arriving at scores for five parameters: Awareness, Satisfaction, Cost of Ownership, Credibility and Loyalty. These five factors are what determine how much the respondents "trust" a brand.

Awareness: Not all of you own a product from all the categories we cover, but buying decisions – in the future for yourself, or even in the present for others who seek your opinion – depend a lot on your awareness and the market's awareness of a brand. You're not likely to buy or recommend something you've never heard of before, are you? To get figures for awareness, we asked the respondents some questions to see how many knew of the brands in this segment. This is again sub-divided into first, unaided recall, such as, "Which is the first brand that comes to mind", and "What other brands are you aware of"; later, we provided people with a list of the brands, and asked them which they were aware of to measure aided recall.

Credibility: Under this heading we questioned respondents about how much they trusted a brand. Questions were asked to gauge what respondents felt about the quality, durability, technological advancement, design, innovativeness, etc., of each brand. This is by far the biggest contributor to the overall trust index, weighing in at 40 per cent.

Satisfaction: As owners of a brand's products, how satisfied you are with their products is one of the key factors that influence how much you trust the brand. In this regard, we questioned

the respondents as to how satisfied they were after purchasing a product, how easily available was it, how hard was it to find information about it, how well-informed were the sales people about the product, how easy was it to get after-sales support. As expected, this was the second biggest factor in determining the overall trust index.

Loyalty: A lot goes into making people stay loyal to a brand. Although our interactions with fan-boys online is not always a good experience, you have to give credit to brands for being able to incite passion in their buyers. To ascertain the loyalty that respondents held for brands, we asked them a series of questions such as "Would you buy another cell phone of the same brand again", and whether, based on their experiences, they would buy a product in a different category from the same brand. We also gauged how eager the respondents were to recommend products from this brand to friends and relatives, and whether the respondent generally spoke positively or negatively about the brand.

Cost of ownership: Not all products can be bought once, used forever. There's expenditure even after the purchase for servicing and repair, which may or may not fall under the warranty period, thus affecting your total cost of ownership. To ascertain this, we asked the respondents a series of questions to determine how much they had spent on a brand after purchase. This factors in the warranty, repair costs, upgrading (if any), etc. We also sought the respondents' opinions about which brands they felt were cheaper to own, overall, as compared to other brands.